individual charging operators' apps by providing users access to participating networks through a common ecosystem. This expands reach for CPOs beyond their own customer bases. Instead of relying solely on users who download their specific app, participating CPOs make their chargers discoverable across multiple consumer-facing platforms connected to UBC. The model optimises charging infrastructure already being deployed across India.

Beyond charging, a unified framework for charging information, access, and payments builds a foundation for other mobility services. Route planners, fleet management platforms, and other applications can leverage charging network data without building separate integrations with every operator.

However, success hinges on operational reliability. Real-time availability, cross-network payments, financial settlements, and data accuracy must work seamlessly. UBC's true test is not just connecting chargers, but ensuring those connections function reliably at scale. Ultimately, its impact on India's EV industry depends on wide participation, precise data, and uptime when drivers need it most.

What's next

UBC's next phase is about expanding access beyond BHIM. While the platform is currently live through the BHIM app, its stated roadmap includes other payment, mobility, and automotive applications. The UBC website specifically lists SUPEREV as in progress and Google Pay, PhonePe, and Paytm as coming soon. These should therefore be described as planned or upcoming integrations, rather than existing ones.

UBC's initial rollout covers participating chargers across cities and national highways, and its expansion will depend on more operators and infrastructure joining the network. Separately, the government has approved 4874 EV chargers under the PM E-DRIVE scheme. However, those chargers should not be presented as UBC chargers unless they are explicitly onboarded to the UBC network.

The longer-term role of UBC extends beyond the BHIM app, positioning it as an interoperability layer that other consumer applications can connect to. If more operators, chargers, and applications onboard, EV users could increasingly access charging through platforms they already use, while individual CPOs continue to run the underlying infrastructure.

The key question is whether this common digital layer can become a standard part of India's EV ecosystem. If successful, the technology will sit quietly in the background while different government bodies, charging operators, and consumer apps operate on top of it. For EV users, it means no longer needing to consider which company owns a charger before plugging in.

The practical effect would be a more connected charging network, even as individual operators continue to own and run the underlying infrastructure. EFY

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Who benefits from UBC?

UBC is designed to benefit different participants across the EV ecosystem:

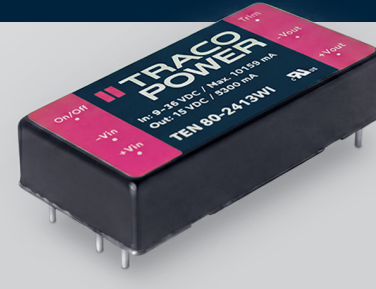
- ***EV users.*** Can discover, reserve, and pay for participating chargers through a common interface, instead of managing multiple charging apps. They can also compare pricing and access real-time charger information
- ***CPOs.*** Can make their chargers visible across multiple consumer platforms, helping them reach more users, improve charger utilisation, and receive payments directly through digital payment systems
- ***Governments and policymakers.*** Can use a unified charging network to improve the use of public charging infrastructure, identify areas with limited charging access, and support wider EV and clean-energy goals
- ***OEMs and fleet operators.*** Vehicle makers can integrate charging access into vehicle infotainment systems, while fleet operators can manage charging across different networks through a common interface

UBC therefore connects the interests of EV users, charging operators, vehicle makers, fleets, and government bodies through a common digital layer.

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